

Event Information:

EventID :

162

Event Time :

Jun, 21, 2023, 01:51 PM

Rule :

SOC210 - Possible Brute Force Detected on VPN

Level :

Security Analyst

Source Address :

37.19.221.229

Destination Address :

33.33.33.33

Destination Hostname :

Mane

Username :

mane@letsdefend.io

Alert Trigger Reason :

A successful VPN login was detected shortly after failed login attempts from the same source IP address

L1 Note :

I checked the authentication logs and saw many login failures from the same IP address. It was also detected that the same IP address was attempting to login for different users. Successful login looks suspicious after these failed login attempts.

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with IP 37.[.]19.221.229 as the source in the relevant time-frame yielding 10 events. The attacker appears to be attempting a Brute Force attack on the organisation's VPN.

Source Address contains "37.19.221.229"		All Time 🔍
✓ 10 events (before Jun, 21, 2023, 01:51 PM UTC)		< 1 >
< Hide Fields	🕒 Event	
INTERESTING FIELDS		
type	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:43 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=1234 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:43 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-letsd...	
source_address	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:46 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=5026 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:46 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-letsd...	
# source_port	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:45 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=4508 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:45 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-letsd...	
destination_address	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:47 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=3548 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:47 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-letsd...	
# destination_port	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:48 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=37004 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:48 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-lets...	
raw_log	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:49 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=46087 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:49 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-lets...	
	[Jun, 21, 2023, 01:49 PM] source_address=37.19.221.229 source_port=4713 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {'Date': '06-21-2023, 01:49 PM', 'source': '37.19.221.229', 'Dest': 'vpn-letsd...	
1 row selected		

From these network logs we can determine that:

Between 01:43 PM and 01:46 PM, the attacker did not know any valid usernames for the network.

- They tried a series of rhyming, alphabetical guesses: sane, zane, fane, and tane.
- The firewall rejected all of these with the clear message: "user name does not exist".

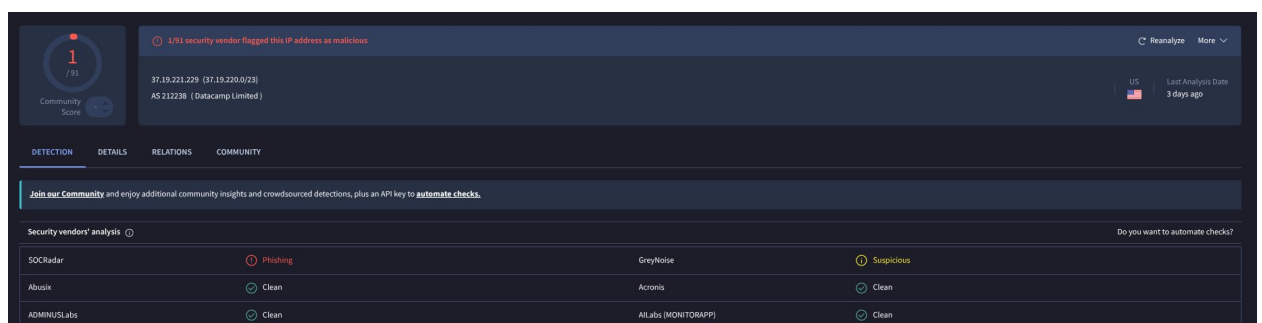
At 01:47 PM, the attacker got a hit. They guessed mane@letsdefend.io.

- The firewall responded with a new message: "user name is correct but the password is wrong".
- Now knowing they had a valid account, the attacker completely stopped guessing usernames.
- From 01:47 PM to 01:50 PM, they focused entirely on Mane's account, rapidly firing multiple password guesses to try and break in.

At 01:51 PM, the brute-force attack succeeded.

- The firewall recorded a "Login Successful" action for mane@letsdefend.io.
- The attacker, operating from IP 37[.]19.221.229, obtained authenticated access to the corporate VPN.

The offending IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a US address associated with 37.19.221.229 AS 212238 (Datacamp Limited). 1/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious.



On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 75 times with a 25% confidence of abuse.

37.19.221.229 was found in our database!

This IP was reported **75** times. Confidence of Abuse is **25%**:

?

25%

ISP	Datacamp Limited
Usage Type	Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit
ASN	AS212238
Hostname(s)	unn-37-19-221-229.datapacket.com
Domain Name	datacamp.co.uk
Country	 United States of America
City	Houston, Texas

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a successful True Positive for a VPN brute force attack.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a successful True Positive brute-force attack against the corporate VPN. An external threat actor systematically enumerated usernames before successfully brute-forcing the password for the account mane[@]letsdefend[.]io.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC210 - Possible Brute Force Detected on VPN
- **Target Account:** mane[@]letsdefend[.]io
- **Attacker IP:** 37[.]19.221.229
- **Destination IP:** 33[.]33.33.33

Analysis and Evidence

- **Username Enumeration:** Between 01:43 PM and 01:46 PM, network logs show the attacker attempting to log in with a series of rhyming usernames (sane, zane, fane, tane). The firewall rejected all of these with a "user name does not exist" action.
- **Password Brute-Forcing:** At 01:47 PM, the attacker successfully identified a valid account (mane[@]letsdefend[.]io), receiving a "user name is correct but the password is wrong" response. From 01:47 PM to 01:50 PM, the attacker focused solely on this account, submitting multiple rapid password guesses.
- **Success Confirmation:** At 01:51 PM, the firewall recorded a "Login Successful" action for mane[@]letsdefend[.]io, confirming the attacker obtained authenticated access to the VPN.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT (Infrastructure):** The attacking IP (37[.]19.221.229) is an external US address associated with Datacamp Limited (AS 212238) in Houston, Texas.
- **Reputation:** VirusTotal flags the IP with 1/91 vendor detections for phishing. AbuseIPDB lists 75 reports with a 25% confidence of abuse. The IP is not in the internal CTI database.
- **Internal Correlation:** No internal communications indicate authorised penetration testing involving this IP during the relevant time-frame.

Actions Taken

- Analysed firewall and authentication logs to trace the brute-force attack from the initial username enumeration phase to the targeted password guessing.
- Verified the successful compromise of the mane[@]letsdefend[.]io account by correlating the "Login Successful" firewall event.
- Investigated the attacker infrastructure via OSINT (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB).
- Isolated the endpoint from the network.
- Declared the alert as a True Positive and escalated.

Let's Defend Result

SOC210 - Possible Brute Force Detected on VPN

True Positive (+5 Point)

Does the device need to be isolated? (+5 Point)

Log Management (+5 Point)

Enrichment & Context (+5 Point)